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Cut in federal workers was deep and wide

Veterans Affairs, Treasury, and the military were big losers

By Julian E.J. Sorapuru,
Yoohyun Jung,
and John Hancock

GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — The federal workforce shrank by nearly 220,000 people last year, close to 10 percent, according to a Globe analysis of federal data. Almost every agency was affected by staff reduc-

tions.

The data — released by the Office of Personnel Management, or OPM, the executive branch's human resources division — offers the clearest picture yet of the Trump administration's cuts to the nation's largest employer in 2025.

Generally, the bigger the agency, the more positions were eliminat-

ed. The departments of Veterans Affairs, the Army, Navy, Air Force, and Treasury were among those that lost the most staff.

Smaller agencies that were explicitly targeted by the Trump administration for cuts, meanwhile, lost outsize portions of their staff, such as the US Agency for International Development, the National

Foundation on Arts and Humanities, and the Department of Education.

The results at the regional level, in New England, and state level, in Massachusetts, generally reflected national trends in the data. Massachusetts lost most of its federal workers from the Veterans Health Administration, Internal Revenue Service, National Park Service, and

WORKFORCE, Page A6

FEDERAL
EMPLOYEES
LOST IN
2025 BY THE
NUMBERS

Nearly 10%

How much the federal workforce shrank, about 220,000 people

329,000

The number of federal workers who left or were removed from their role

41,561

The number of losses at Veterans Health Administration, the hardest-hit agency

489

The number of agencies affected



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

The Poor Clare nuns are hoping to expand their current home in Westwood. Above, Sister Leticia (left) and Sister Nativity.

Praying for a resolution

Sale of nuns' now-vacant monastery held up over concerns about effect on Arboretum

By Catherine Carlock

GLOBE STAFF

WESTWOOD — A brass bell rang out on a recent midwinter afternoon at the Monastery of St. Clare, calling together the property's 11 nuns.

Their monastic schedule starts at 6:15 a.m. with morning prayer, then Mass, breakfast, and meditation, much as their order has done for the past eight centuries.

The cloistered sisters of St. Clare live a quiet life of contemplation and service to others, donning habits and keeping vows of poverty. Across the country, another 10 sisters wait to join them.

A deal to sell the Poor Clares' former monastery alongside the Arnold Arboretum in Jamaica Plain and use the proceeds to expand their new home in Westwood has been delayed, for years now, as Boston offi-

cials contemplate how best to protect the historic park.

The Boston Planning Department is "urgently working" on its review of a proposal, first pitched nearly three years ago, to build 123 apartments and condos at the vacant former monastery site, a spokesperson said. But until the city approves the project, the sale can't go through, leaving the nuns in a

POOR CLARE, Page A7

Columbia student's arrest sets off alarms

ICE agents enter apartment despite the school's policy; Mass. has similar safeguards

By Laura Crimaldi and Brooke Hauser

GLOBE STAFF

The arrest of an international student inside her Columbia University residence Thursday morning by immigration agents triggered fresh alarm, confusion, and protests after a short period of relative calm had settled on many campuses.

The incident comes as Massachusetts officials have sought to harden the protections for the many colleges and universities in the state that have numbers of international students.

In New York, immigration agents gained entry to the apartment of Ellie Aghayeva, a senior from Azerbaijan studying neuroscience and political science, by claiming to search for a missing person, according to a petition from her lawyers and a statement released by Columbia.

Aghayeva is also a social-media influencer with sizable followings on Instagram, YouTube, and TikTok, where she shares glimpses of her life studying at the library or following a skin care routine.

The incident echoed the dramatic arrest last March of Rümeysa Öztürk, a Tufts University graduate student from Turkey. Masked federal immigration agents detained her on a Somerville

COLUMBIA, Page A5

Tenants fight being charged landlord legal fees in eviction cases

By Mara Kardas-Nelson

GLOBE STAFF

At first, Lisa Almeida felt like she had caught a break.

In 2014, through a lottery run by the City of Somerville, Almeida, a visiting nurse, won a spot for lower-income tenants at Avalon at Assembly Row. She would pay \$1,200 for a two-bedroom for her and her two kids.

Almost as soon as she moved in, Almeida was hit with fees she did not expect: \$25 for a key lock change, \$286 for "scheduler move-in fee," \$65 to amend her lease. Almeida could afford the \$1,200 base rent but couldn't keep up with the additional fees.

Then, when she fell behind on monthly payments, Almeida was startled by another charge: legal fees when her landlord, AvalonBay, tried to evict her. While her cases never made it before a judge and were eventually dismissed by her land-

LEGAL FEES, Page A6



JOSH REYNOLDS FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

"I don't want anyone to ever go through what I went through," Lisa Almeida said.



Slush fun

Friday: Seasonable.
High 38-43. Low 28-33.

Saturday: Warming up.
High 46-51. Low 29-34.

Weather and Comics, G6-7.

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Woods Hole scientists announced promising preliminary results in an experiment to make the ocean less acidic to reverse global warming. **B1.**

Democrats fear the midterm elections could be subverted by an increasingly emboldened President Trump, who appears to be trying to undermine faith they will be free and fair. **A2.**

Birds in the United States are declining at a faster rate, particularly in warm and warming areas, raising alarms. **A2.**

The T plans to procure 20 new commuter rail locomotives — 10 battery-electric and 10 diesel — to boost its fleet. **B1.**

Actor's ART lawsuit reflects deeper issues about Black hair

By Malcolm Gay

GLOBE STAFF

For more than five years, the American Repertory Theater has made no secret of its ambition to become an antiracist organization. The Harvard University-based theater has published Indigenous land acknowledgments, hired consultants, and posted a series of reports that chronicle its effort to embed "anti-racism as a core value."

So it was perhaps surprising when a Black actor sued the theater last week for race discrimination, alleging a botched hairstyle had left her with "permanent hair loss and painful

scalp damage" as well as "severe emotional distress, depression, and panic attacks."

The case adds to the long, fraught history that Black people's hair has had in the struggle for racial equality. Along with skin tone, hair for Black people is a potent social and physical marker, and over the years it has served by turns as a means of denigration, assimilation, resistance, and liberation.

"Black hair is sort of inherently political in that it's always being measured against white ideals around beauty and professionalism," said

HAIR, Page A7

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